

Turmoil as Ottawa prepares for Trump

Canada’s government in disarray as incoming U.S. president taunts Trudeau

BY AMANDA COLETTA

TORONTO — Canada’s government is melting down at the worst possible moment.

The country is girding for the return of Donald Trump, whom many here see as an existential threat to Canada’s security. He has threatened to slap 25 percent tariffs on Canadian goods, levies that could crush the economy of a country that sends nearly 80 percent of its exports to its southern neighbor.

And he has taken to mocking embattled Prime Minister Justin Trudeau as the “governor” of the “great state of Canada” in middle-of-the-night social media posts that officials here have sought to cast as lighthearted ribbing but others view as not-so-neighborly and not-so-funny. On Christmas, Trump said he’d pitched hockey great Wayne Gretzky on becoming Canada’s next prime minister.

Now, weeks before Trump’s return, Trudeau is dealing with the bombshell resignation from his cabinet of Chrystia Freeland, long one of his most loyal and powerful lieutenants.

Trudeau and his Liberal Party were already struggling in polls. Freeland’s abrupt announcement — even some friends were taken by surprise — has thrown his government into disarray. Adversaries

SEE CANADA ON A9

Israel ramped up use of AI in Gaza war

BY ELIZABETH DWOSKIN

After the brutal Oct. 7, 2023, attack by Hamas, the Israel Defense Forces deluged Gaza with bombs, drawing on a database painstakingly compiled through the years that detailed home addresses, tunnels and other infrastructure critical to the militant group.

But then the target bank ran low. To maintain the war’s breakneck pace, the IDF turned to an elaborate artificial intelligence tool called Habsora — or “the Gospel” — which could quickly generate hundreds of additional targets.

The use of AI to rapidly refill IDF’s target bank allowed the military to continue its campaign uninterrupted, according to two people familiar with the operation. It is an example of how the decade-long program to place advanced AI tools at the center of IDF’s intelligence operations has contributed to the violence of Israel’s 14-month war in Gaza.

The IDF has broadcast the existence of these programs, which constitute what some experts consider the most advanced military AI initiative ever to be deployed. But a Washington Post investigation reveals previously unreported details of the inner workings of the machine-learning program, along with the secretive, decade-long history of its development.

The investigation also reveals a fierce debate within the highest

SEE ISRAEL ON A11

JIMMY CARTER 1924-2024



BILL O’LEARY/THE WASHINGTON POST

Former president Jimmy Carter at his home in Plains, Georgia, in 2010. He had been under hospice care since February 2023.

One-term president who shone after the White House

The 39th president was noted for a lifetime of service, earning a Nobel Peace Prize

BY KEVIN SULLIVAN AND EDWARD WALSH

Jimmy Carter, a no-frills and steel-willed Southern governor who was elected president in 1976, was rejected by disillusioned voters after a single term and went on to an extraordinary post-presidential life that included winning the Nobel Peace Prize, died Sunday at his home in Plains, Georgia, according to his son James E. Carter III, known as Chip. He was 100 and the oldest living U.S. president of all time.

A cause of death was not immediately provided. In a statement in February 2023, the Carter Center said the former president, after a series of hospital stays, would stop further medical treatment and spend his remaining time at home under hospice care. He had been treated in recent years for an aggressive form of melanoma, a skin cancer, with tumors that spread to his liver and brain.

His wife, Rosalynn, died Nov. 19, 2023, at 96. The Carters, who were close partners in public life, had been married for more than 77 years, the longest presidential marriage in U.S. history. One of his final public appearances was at her funeral in Plains, where he sat in the front row in a wheelchair. Carter was last photographed outside his home with family and friends as he watched a flyover on Oct. 1 held to mark his 100th birthday.

Building a legacy: Later work was defining. **A3**
11 facts: Including a scandal in Britain. **A3**

Mr. Carter is survived by his children Jack, Chip, Jeff and Amy; 11 grandchildren; and 14 great-grandchildren, according to the Carter Center.

“My father was a hero, not only to me but to everyone who believes in peace, human rights, and unselfish love,” Chip Carter said in a statement. “My brothers, sister, and I shared him with the rest of the world through these common beliefs. The world is our family because of the way he brought people together, and we thank you for honoring his memory by continuing to live these shared beliefs.”

The Carter Center said Sunday that public observances will be held in Atlanta and Washington, to be followed by a private interment in Plains. President Joe Biden said he ordered a national day of mourning on Jan. 9, but other details for the final arrangements, including all public events and motorcade routes, are pending.

“Jimmy Carter stands up as a model of what it means to live a life of meaning and purpose, a life of principle, faith and humility,” Biden said in remarks Sunday night. “What I find extraordinary about Jimmy Carter though is that millions of people all around the world, all over

SEE CARTER ON A4

‘A dear friend’: Leaders recall life of service. **A6**
Timeline: The highs and lows of Carter’s life. **A6**

Plane crash in S. Korea kills 179

OFFICIALS SEARCH FOR ANSWERS

World’s deadliest such incident in six years

BY KELLY KASULIS CHO, IAN DUNCAN AND LEO SANDS

SEOUL — Investigators were working to understand why a passenger plane crashed at a South Korean airport on Sunday, killing all but two people aboard in the world’s deadliest plane crash in six years.

One hundred and seventy-nine people died, the country’s National Fire Agency confirmed. Two members of the crew survived, the agency said.

Authorities said the flight crew was warned about birds in the area, but analysts said it would be exceptionally rare for a strike to force a large passenger plane into a fiery crash-landing like Sunday’s.

Jeju Air Flight 2216 from Bangkok crash-landed at Muan International Airport near the southern tip of South Korea and burst into a fireball at around 9 a.m. local time.

Video showed the Boeing 737-800 veering down the runway without its landing gear deployed, hitting a wall and bursting into flames.

SEE SOUTH KOREA ON A10

Companies mail vapes despite restrictions

Online retailers openly flout laws against shipping e-cigarettes

BY DAVID OVALLE AND RACHEL ROUBEIN

Mango, cherry and lemonade-flavored vapes — they’re delivered by mail carriers like any letter, pamphlet or package. One problem: It’s illegal in most cases to ship those products.

Still, vapes arrive regularly on the doorsteps of homes across the nation as companies flout laws regulating online sales of the products, including a ban on shipping e-cigarettes through the U.S. Postal Service. The internet is flooded with online retailers, some that advertise on social media, others that change names frequently, all of which operate as part of a broader e-commerce system that delivers millions of packages of all kinds every day.

Enforcement is complicated by a patchwork of regulations at the federal, state and local levels. While it’s not legal for the Postal Service or major companies such as UPS to ship e-cigarettes, smaller services are allowed to ferry vapes — but only if they verify the age of the customer and receive the signature of an adult, a step that studies show is often skipped.

“It’s a massive game of whack-a-mole from an enforcement stand-

SEE VAPE ON A2

IN THE NEWS

Commanders clinch playoff spot It took overtime, but a 30-24 victory against Atlanta secured a postseason berth for Washington for the first time since the 2020 season. **D1**

Celebrating Kwanzaa Families observe the week-long holiday at the Anacostia Community Museum. **B1**

THE NATION
Winter outerwear for dogs has become increasingly popular, but it’s not only about fashion — experts say clothing is important for breeds that are vulnerable to cold weather. **A2**

THE NATION
Classical music lessons have helped Kenyan children find a way out of Nairobi’s poorest districts, with some alumni of the Ghetto Classics program now studying abroad. **A8**

THE ECONOMY
Looming uncertainties — particularly involving tariffs and immigration — could lead to big changes for the economy in 2025. **A13**
Meme stocks continued to have a moment in 2024, but you should take caution before you jump into the fray. **A13**

THE REGION
A mezzanine that has seen its cost grow twentyfold is emblematic of the increasing cost of the Purple Line project in Maryland. **B1**
The newborn pygmy hippo at the Metro Richmond Zoo is drawing comparisons to viral sensation Moo Deng. **B1**

STYLE
In “Nickel Boys,” an adaptation of Colson Whitehead’s Pulitzer Prize-winning 2019 novel, director RaMell Ross uses a first-person perspective to force viewers to share in the horrors endured by two Black teens at an abusive school. **C1**

BUSINESS NEWS.....A13
COMICS.....C5
OBITUARIES.....B5
OPINION PAGES.....A14
TELEVISION.....C4
WORLD NEWS.....A8

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The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54081

